

Cat Litter Box Solutions — Action Checklist

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RULE OUT MEDICAL CAUSES

- ☐ **Schedule a vet appointment immediately if your cat strains to urinate with little output, cries in the litter box, has blood in urine, or shows lethargy alongside avoidance behavior.:** Schedule a vet appointment immediately if your cat strains to urinate with little output, cries in the litter box, has blood in urine, or shows lethargy alongside avoidance behavior.
- ☐ **Request a urinalysis test that checks for infection, crystals, and blood when you visit the vet for litter box avoidance issues.:** Request a urinalysis test that checks for infection, crystals, and blood when you visit the vet for litter box avoidance issues.
- ☐ **Ask your vet to run a full blood panel that rules out kidney disease, diabetes, and hyperthyroidism as potential medical causes.:** Ask your vet to run a full blood panel that rules out kidney disease, diabetes, and hyperthyroidism as potential medical causes.
- ☐ **Do not accept a behavioral diagnosis without medical testing — insist on urinalysis, blood work, and bladder palpitation before treating the issue as environmental.:** Do not accept a behavioral diagnosis without medical testing — insist on urinalysis, blood work, and bladder palpitation before treating the issue as environmental.

AUDIT THE LITTER BOX ENVIRONMENT

- ☐ **Add one litter box per cat plus one extra, placing them in separate areas of your home to eliminate territorial sharing disputes.:** Add one litter box per cat plus one extra, placing them in separate areas of your home to eliminate territorial sharing disputes.
 - ☐ **Switch from a covered litter box to an uncovered one because covered boxes trap ammonia odor inside, which overwhelms sensitive feline noses.:** Switch from a covered litter box to an uncovered one because covered boxes trap ammonia odor inside, which overwhelms sensitive feline noses.
 - ☐ **Replace scented litter with unscented clumping litter at minimum 2-inch depth, since strong fragrances are a common avoidance trigger for cats.:** Replace scented litter with unscented clumping litter at minimum 2-inch depth, since strong fragrances are a common avoidance trigger for cats.
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- ☐ **Scoop the litter box at least once daily and completely empty and clean it with hot water and mild soap every 4–6 weeks.:** Scoop the litter box at least once daily and completely empty and clean it with hot water and mild soap every 4–6 weeks.

REDUCE MULTI-CAT HOUSEHOLD TENSION

- ☐ **Look for signs of multi-cat tension including one cat waiting near the box, chasing behavior, increased hiding, or dispute-like vocalizations that may be driving avoidance.:** Look for signs of multi-cat tension including one cat waiting near the box, chasing behavior, increased hiding, or dispute-like vocalizations that may be driving avoidance.
- ☐ **Add vertical space with cat trees or shelves so the targeted cat can escape tension and access the box without confrontation.:** Add vertical space with cat trees or shelves so the targeted cat can escape tension and access the box without confrontation.
- ☐ **Separate food and water stations for each cat in different locations to reduce competition that contributes to stress-related elimination problems.:** Separate food and water stations for each cat in different locations to reduce competition that contributes to stress-related elimination problems.
- ☐ **Use Feliway Classic diffusers to reduce baseline stress in multi-cat homes since peer-reviewed studies demonstrate it decreases stress-related inappropriate urination.:** Use Feliway Classic diffusers to reduce baseline stress in multi-cat homes since peer-reviewed studies demonstrate it decreases stress-related inappropriate urination.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.